Cultivating Excellence

NFL's Journey in transforming Indian Fertilizer Sector

In the ever-evolving landscape of the fertilizer industry, **Dr. U. Saravanan** stands as a beacon of innovation and resilience. As the Chairman and Managing Director (CMD) of National Fertilizers Limited (NFL), he has steered the company through unprecedented challenges to achieve record-breaking success including achieving Navratna Status to NFL. With a focus on sustainability, community development, and operational excellence and vision of being a leading Indian company in fertilizers and beyond, NFL has navigated through significant challenges achieving remarkable growth and innovation. In this exclusive Q&A, Dr. U. Saravanan unfolds the strategic brilliance behind NFL's initiatives, outlining the transformative path that will shape the future of Indian Fertilizer industry.



DR. U. SARAVANAN
Chairman and Managing Director (CMD)
National Fertilizers Limited (NFL)

Q&A

- **Dr. Saravanan, could you share with us your journey since your appointment as Chairman & Managing Director of NFL?**
  I was appointed as the Chairman & Managing Director of National Fertilizers Limited (NFL) effective from June 16, 2023. During my tenure at NFL, the Company has reached a significant milestone, as it has been honoured with the prestigious Navratna Status by the Government of India.

  When I first joined this esteemed company, I had a vision of turning the company in to a Navratna PSU from a Miniratna PSU. Today, I am glad to see that the same vision has materialized into reality.

  My tenure at NFL had been marked with significant challenges and transformative initiatives, but our team's dedication and strategic initiatives have led us to excellent results.

- **Please highlight NFL's contribution in the agriculture growth of the Nation?**
  NFL has always been a cornerstone of the Indian agriculture since green revolution. The company is commemorating 50 glorious years of its existence on August 23, 2024. For the past five decades since 1974, NFL has been dedicatedly serving farmers and making pivotal contributions in the agricultural development of the nation, thereby fostering self-sufficiency in food production.

- **Could you elaborate on the challenges NFL faced in the last few years and how the company navigated through them?**
  The recent years have been exceptionally challenging for the Indian fertilizer industry, largely due to the geopolitical conflict between Russia and Ukraine. This conflict severely disrupted the supply chain, causing a significant spike in the prices of fertilizers and raw materials, and escalating production costs due to high energy prices. Despite these hurdles, the Indian government acted proactively to facilitate both production and import of fertilizers.

  At NFL, we have leveraged our robust operational efficiency, strong marketing network and strategic diversification into Non-Urea segments, to mitigate these challenges. Our expansion of marketing territories and energy-efficient operations led us to an unprecedented performance in production and sales.

- **Could you provide more details about NFL's manufacturing plants and their capacities?**
  NFL operates five gas-based Ammonia-Urea plants located in Nangal and Bathinda in Punjab, Panipat in Haryana, and two plants in Vijaipur, Dist. Guna Madhya Pradesh. Together, these plants have an annual installed capacity of 35.68 LMT, making NFL the second-largest Urea producer in India and largest Urea producer among PSUs, with a 16% share of the country's total Urea production.

  We have a Bio-Fertilizers Plant at Vijaipur, with a capacity of producing 600 tons of solid and liquid Bio-Fertilizers and a 25,000 MT Bentonite Sulphur plant in Panipat. The company also produces Industrial Products viz. Nitric Acid, Ammonium Nitrate and Sodium Nitrate at its Nangal Plant. Additionally, we have 3 Seed Processing Units at Bathida, Panipat and Indore and our agrochemical manufacturing unit is based at Bathinda.

  Further, we are also coming up with our own Nano Urea plant at NFL Nangal Unit and Gold Urea plant at NFL Panipat Unit.

